Unit 1 Section 1 – Meeting Customer Needs

Exam Patterns & Trends

Exam Series	Topics Tested	Question Type
Jan 2019	Market segmentation / mass vs niche	4–8 marks
Jun 2020	Market research methods / sampling	6–10 marks
Jan 2021	Product differentiation / USP	8 marks
Oct 2021	Market mapping / orientation	10 marks
Jun 2022	Dynamic markets / innovation	8 marks
Jan 2023	Market research – Tesla sampling	10 marks
Oct 2024	Adding value / market orientation	8 marks

Summary of Patterns

Market research and sampling appear in every cycle, often as accessible 4–8 mark questions. PED and differentiation rotate roughly every three years. Online retailing and innovation recur in 8–10 mark discussion questions, usually in January sittings. Market mapping and orientation feature in 10-mark or extended essays for new business contexts.

Predictions for Jan 2026

- Market research reliability and sampling accuracy
- Price elasticity (PED) linked to pricing strategy
- Product differentiation and added value
- Market mapping and orientation
- Online retailing as a dynamic market theme